and personal beliefs. The regular hospital diet is simple in character and preparation. This diet is easily digested. It gives maximum nourishment with minimum effort to the body. The diet is well balanced, adequate in nutritional value and attractively served to stimulate a possible poor appetite. This diet gives 1800-2000kcal and 42-45g of protein.

## 5.3. Special feeding methods:

In instances when a patient is unable to ingest food orally, through any of the routine hospital diets, special feeding methods are used to supply the adequate nutrients.

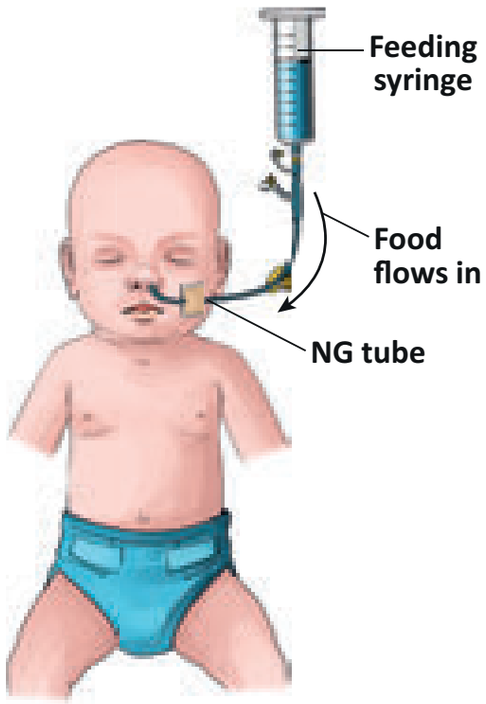
**Resorting to special feeding methods are due to the below reasons:**

- An acute illness which does not allow the patient to eat normally.
- Decreased appetite as side effects of drugs.
- Anorexia.
- Difficulties in swallowing due to oral / laryngeal cancer, paralysis of swallowing muscles as in diphtheria and poliomyelitis.
- Some type of surgery that interferes with eating.
- Short bowel syndrome.
- Very low birth weight in infants
- Severe malnutrition or malabsorption syndrome.
- Semi- conscious or unconscious patients.
- GI problems interfering digestion and absorption of food.
- Chronic neurological problems.
- Mechanical dysphagia.
- Gut dysfunction.
- Kidney disorders.

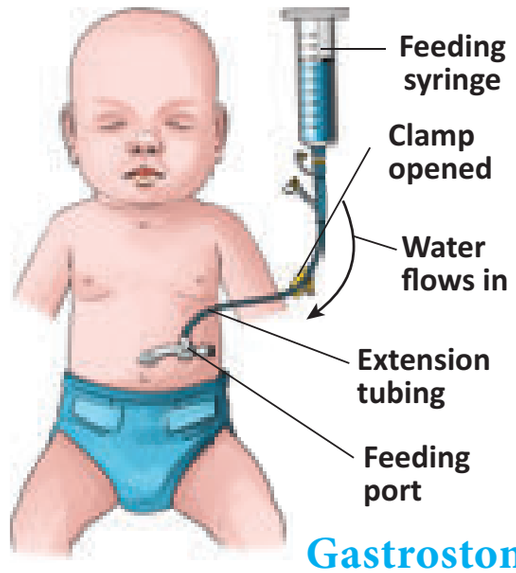
### Types of special feeding methods:

### 5.3.1. Enteral or tube feeding:

Tube feeding is when a special liquid food mixture containing the necessary nutrients like protein, carbohydrates, fats, vitamins and minerals , is given through a tube into the stomach or duodenum. The process can be by insertion of a tube into the nose – nasogastric or nasoenteral feeding or surgically inserting into the stomach (duodenum – gastrostomy or jejunostomy).




Nasogastric




Gastrostomy



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